
Bill Catch-Up Plan Toolkit

Stop Late Fees + Get Current

Instant Download | Start in 10 minutes

- Priority Payment Order (what to pay first when money is tight)
- Money Triage Worksheet (see what's due fast)
- 14-Day Catch-Up Calendar + 30-Day Plan
- Call/Text Scripts (extensions, payment plans, fee waivers)
- "Short Month" Plan (3 options when you can't cover everything)

Quick Start

Use this toolkit when you're behind on bills and need a clear plan for what to pay first. You can complete this in one sitting.

How to use (3 steps):

1

List your bills + due dates using the Money Triage Worksheet.

2

Follow the Priority Payment Order to decide what gets paid first.

3

Map your next 14–30 days with the Catch-Up Calendar so you stay on track.

Tip: Keep moving—progress beats perfection. Protect housing, utilities, and transportation first.

Money Triage Worksheet

Fill this out first. It gives you a clear view of what's due and what needs attention right now.

Bill / Company	Due Date	Past Due? (Y/N)	Minimum Due	Balance (opt.)	Notes / Action

Optional: Mark the bills that could be negotiated (late fee waiver / extension / payment plan).

Priority Payment Order

When money is tight, pay in this order to protect the essentials first.

1	Housing	Rent / mortgage (keep a roof over your head)
2	Utilities	Electric / water / gas (keep services on)
3	Transportation	Car note + insurance + gas (protect ability to work)
4	Phone / Internet	Especially if needed for work/school
5	Minimum debt payments	Pay minimums to avoid extra fees when possible
6	Essentials	Food + medications
7	Everything else	Subscriptions, extras, non-essentials

“Short Month” Plan (pick one):

Cut:	Pause non-essentials for 7–30 days (subscriptions, extras).
Shift:	Move due dates / split payments (call using the scripts).
Extend:	Request an extension or payment plan to avoid shut-offs/fees.

14-Day Catch-Up Calendar

Map your next two weeks. Write the bill, amount, and the action you'll take.

Next 7 Days

[illegible]

Days 8–14

[illegible]

Call / Text Scripts

Use these scripts to ask for an extension, payment plan, or late-fee waiver. Keep it short and calm.

1) Extension Request

Hi, I'm calling about my account. I'm experiencing a temporary hardship and want to stay in good standing. Can I get an extension until [DATE]? I can pay [\$AMOUNT] on [DATE]. Can you confirm any fees and send the agreement by email?

2) Payment Plan Request

Hi, I want to set up a payment plan so my account stays current. I can pay [\$AMOUNT] today and [\$AMOUNT] on [DATE]. What options are available and what fees apply? Can you send the plan details in writing?

3) Late Fee Waiver Request

Hi, I noticed a late fee on my account. I'm working to catch up and would like to request a one-time courtesy waiver. I can make a payment of [\$AMOUNT] today. Can you remove the fee and confirm the new balance?

4) Confirm in Writing (Text/Email)

Thanks for your help today. To confirm, we agreed to: [EXTENSION/PLAN DETAILS]. My next payment is [\$AMOUNT] on [DATE]. Please reply to confirm. Thank you.

Reminder: Ask for the representative's name and note the date/time of the call on your calendar.